

# CYNTHIA BOO

(she/her)

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## ACADEMIC POSITIONS

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|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 – Present | <b>Postdoctoral Research Associate</b> , <i>New York University (NYU)</i><br>Department of Psychology<br>Advisor: Dr. Marjorie Rhodes |
| 2025 – 2026    | Department of Communicative Sciences & Disorders<br>Advisor: Dr. Sudha Arunachalam                                                    |

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## EDUCATION

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019 – 2024 | <b>Ph.D., Psychological Sciences   Developmental Concentration</b> , <i>University of Connecticut (UConn)</i><br>Dissertation: <i>Dyadic speech between friends: Insights into friendship via language use</i><br>Committee Chair: Dr. Letitia Naigles                                                     |
| 2022 – 2023 | <b>Graduate Certificate, Cognitive Sciences</b> , <i>UConn</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 2019 – 2021 | <b>M.S., Psychological Sciences   Developmental Concentration</b> , <i>UConn</i><br>Thesis: <i>Structural and pragmatic language abilities of children with ASD, ADHD, and comorbid symptoms of both during conversational discourse in a virtual reality task</i><br>Committee Chair: Dr. Letitia Naigles |
| 2017 – 2019 | <b>M.A., General Psychology</b> , <i>The New School for Social Research (NSSR)</i><br>Thesis: <i>Cultural variation in real-life narrative styles of social support</i><br>Advisor: Dr. Joan Miller                                                                                                        |
| 2014 – 2017 | <b>B.S., Psychology</b> , <i>Juniata College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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## FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, & AWARDS

### *Fellowships & Honors*

|             |                                                                                             |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024        | <b>Summer Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$2,000)                     |
| 2022 – 2023 | <b>Cognitive Science Graduate Fellowship</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$2,000)                       |
| 2022        | <b>College of Liberal Arts and Sciences Graduate Fellowship</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$1,000)    |
| 2021 – 2022 | <b>National Science Foundation (DGE-1747486) Student Traineeship</b> , <i>SLAC at UConn</i> |
| 2022        | <b>IBACS Graduate Student Summer Fellow</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$5,000)                        |
| 2020 – 2023 | <b>Provost's Letter for Excellence in Teaching</b> , <i>UConn</i>                           |
| 2017 – 2019 | <b>Merit Scholarship</b> , <i>NSSR</i> (\$25,000 per year)                                  |

### *Travel Awards*

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | <b>SRCD 2025 Biennial Early Career Travel Award</b> , <i>Society for Research in Child Development</i> (\$500) |
| 2024 | <b>Psychological Sciences Departmental Travel Award</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$500)                                 |
| 2024 | <b>Institute of Brain and Cognitive Sciences (IBACS) Travel Award</b> , <i>UConn</i> (\$500)                   |
| 2023 | <b>Student Bursary</b> , <i>International Pragmatics Association</i> (€ 1,700)                                 |
| 2023 | <b>Student &amp; Trainee Travel Award</b> , <i>International Society for Autism Research</i> (\$500)           |

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|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | <b>Conference Participation Award, UConn (\$750)</b>                                 |
| 2023 | <b>Travel Award, Science of Learning and Communication (SLAC) at UConn (\$2,000)</b> |
| 2022 | <b>Travel Award, SLAC at UConn (\$165)</b>                                           |

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## PUBLICATIONS

+ graduate student mentee

### *Peer-Reviewed Publications*

- Kalvey, M.<sup>+</sup>, **Boo, C.**, & Rhodes, M. (2026) How does language bias memory for gender stereotypes? In the *Proceedings of the 2026 Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, vol. 48.
- Boo, C.** & Naigles, L. (2025). The influence of discourse context on children's use of conversational devices. In the *49<sup>th</sup> Proceedings of the Boston University Conference on Language Development*, 115-128.
- Tsudaka, G., Wienk, M.N.A., Berkessel, J., & **Boo, C.** (2025). Rugged terrain and rigid hierarchy. *Current Research in Ecological and Social Psychology*, 8, 100220. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cresp.2025.100220>
- Boo, C.**, Alpers-Leon, N., McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., Naigles, L. (2022). Conversation during a virtual reality task reveals new structural language profiles of children with ASD, ADHD, and comorbid symptoms of both. *Journal of Autism and Developmental Disorders*, 52, 2970–2983. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10803-021-05175-6>

### *Submitted Manuscripts*

- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., Naigles, L. (in revision). Discourse markers are not solely pragmatic: Insights from neurodivergent speakers.

### *Manuscripts in Preparation*

- Crespo, K., **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. Language and second-order theory of mind in autistic and non-autistic young adults.
- Boo, C.**, Smith, R., & Naigles, L. Language as a window into children's friendship quality: Conversational markers of closeness and discord.
- Vasil, J., **Boo, C.**, Johnson, J. Cordeiro, S., Boudreau, G., & Rhodes, M. Comparison of measures of children's gender stereotyping in academic domains.
- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., Grossman, R., Naigles, L., Zane, E. Non-autistic and autistic children: Why should I say "um" if I'm not talking to anybody?

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## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

\* undergraduate student mentee, + graduate student mentee

### *Talks*

- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., McIntyre, N., Grossman, R., Mundy, P., Naigles, L., & Zane, E. (July 2023). Non-autistic & autistic children: Why should I say "um" if I'm not talking to anybody? Talk presented at the International Pragmatics Conference, Brussels, Belgium.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (July 2021). Discourse marker production in verbally fluent school-aged children with ASD and ADHD in a virtual reality task. Talk presented at the International Association for the Study of Child Language (Virtual conference).

### *Posters*

- Kalvey, M.<sup>+</sup>, **Boo, C.**, & Rhodes, M. (July 2026) How does language bias memory for gender stereotypes? Poster to be presented at the Cognitive Science Society meeting, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
- Boo, C.**, Zhou, Y.<sup>\*</sup>, & Rhodes, M. (April 2026). Parental linguistic scope matters in children's gender essentialism beyond children's explicit verbal agreement. Poster presented at Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, Canada.
- Kalvey, M.<sup>+</sup>, **Boo, C.**, & Rhodes, M. (April 2026). How does language bias memory for gender stereotypes? Poster presented at Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, Canada.
- Zhou, Y.<sup>\*</sup>, **Boo, C.**, & Rhodes, M. (February 2026). Linguistic scope matters: Children's responses to parental gendered language. Poster presented at the Eastern Psychological Association, Boston, MA.

- Boo, C.** & Naigles, L. (May 2025). Children's use of particular linguistic devices predicts friendship satisfaction: A Bayesian hierarchical approach. Poster presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.
- Verastegui, N.\*, Corrigan, G., **Boo, C.**, Fusaroli, R., Weed, E., & Naigles, L. (May 2025). Backchanneling behaviors of autistic and neurotypical teenager-caregiver dyads in a cooperative task. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research, Seattle, WA.
- Boo, C.** & Naigles, L. (November 2024). The influence of discourse context on children's use of conversational devices. Poster presented at the 49th Boston University Conference on Language Development, Boston, MA.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (June 2024). Considering the investigator as a co-conversationalist in neurodivergent children's use of discourse markers. Poster presented at the International Max Planck Research School (IMPRS) for Language Sciences conference, Nijmegen, The Netherlands.
- Andalib, Y.\*, **Boo, C.**, Naigles, L. (March 2024). Narrative macrostructure: A comparison between autistic and typically developing adolescents. Poster presented at the Meeting on Language in Autism, Durham, NC.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (March 2024). Variation in autism and ADHD symptomatology reveals differential uses of discourse markers. Poster presented at Meeting on Language in Autism, Durham, NC.
- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., Carmona, J., Grossman, R., Naigles, L., & Zane, E. (May 2023). Non-autistic and autistic teenager's use of "um" varies in monologic versus dialogic discourse contexts. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research, Stockholm, Sweden.
- Cintron, S.\*, **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. (March 2023). Comparison of autistic and typically developing children's vocalizations via the International Phonetic Alphabet. Poster presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.
- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., McIntyre, N., Grossman, R., Mundy, P., Naigles, L., & Zane, E. (March 2023). Non-autistic versus autistic children: Why should I say "um" if I'm not talking to anybody? Poster presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (March 2023). Influence of investigator' discourse marker usage on typically developing children and children with HFA and/or ADHD. Poster presented at Meeting on Language in Autism, Durham, NC.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (May 2022). Differentiating among low, medium, and high "um" users with ASD and ADHD. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research, Austin, TX.
- Carmona, J., **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. (May 2022). Internal state language production in storybook versus personal narratives in TD children and children with ASD. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research, Austin, TX.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (May 2021). Difficulties with personal pronouns for school-aged children with ASD and ADHD in a virtual reality task. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research (Virtual conference).
- Carmona, J., **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. (May 2021). Narrative abilities in teens with autism spectrum disorder across two contexts. Poster presented at the International Society for Autism Research (Virtual conference).
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (April 2021). Comparing language abilities of children with ASD, ADHD, and comorbid symptoms of both. Poster presented at the Society for Research in Child Development (Virtual conference).
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (March 2020). Influence of investigator' discourse marker usage on typically developing children and children with HFA and/or ADHD. Poster to be presented at the Meeting on Language in Autism, Durham, NC. (Canceled due to COVID-19 pandemic).
- Reichert, C., **Boo, C.**, Buser, V., & Gilman, A. (March 2017). Crowd-sourced word ratings reveal qualitative differences among song stimuli. Poster presented at the Eastern Psychological Association Conference, Boston, MA.

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## OTHER PRESENTATIONS

\* undergraduate mentee

## *Talks*

- Boo, C.** (April 2024). Dyadic speech between friends during gameplay: Insights into friendship via language use. Talk presented at the Conceptual Development and Social Cognition Lab at New York University, New York, NY.
- Boo, C.** (March 2024). Dyadic speech between friends during gameplay: Insights into friendship via language use. Talk presented at the 6th Annual Psychological Science Cross-Disciplinary Graduate Colloquium at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.** & Naigles, L. (April 2021). Patterns of filled pause and discourse marker production in children with ASD and ADHD. Talk presented at the Language Acquisition Workshop of New England (LAWNE) at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT (Virtual meeting)

## *Posters*

- Zhou, Y.\*, **Boo, C.**, & Rhodes, M. (May 2026). Linguistic scope matters: Children's responses to parental gendered language. Poster to be presented at the NYU Applied Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference, New York, NY.
- Verastegui, N.\*, Corrigan, G., **Boo, C.**, Fusaroli, R., Weed, E., & Naigles, L. (April 2025). Backchanneling behaviors of autistic and neurotypical teenager-caregiver dyads in a cooperative task. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (April 2024). Variation in autism and ADHD symptomatology reveals differential uses of discourse markers. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Andalib, Y.\*, **Boo, C.**, Naigles, L. (April 2024). Narrative Macrostructure: A comparison between autistic and typically developing adolescents. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., McIntyre, N., Grossman, R., Mundy, P., Naigles, L., & Zane, E. (November 2023). Non-autistic versus autistic children: Why should I say "um" if I'm not talking to anybody? Poster presented at the Annual Psychological Sciences Poster Night at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Cintron, S.\*, **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. (April 2023). Comparison of autistic and typically developing children's vocalizations via the International Phonetic Alphabet. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, Shield, A., McIntyre, N., Grossman, R., Mundy, P., Naigles, L., & Zane, E. (April 2023). Non-autistic versus autistic children: Why should I say "um" if I'm not talking to anybody? Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (October 2022). Differentiating among low, medium, and high "um" users with ASD and ADHD. Poster presented at the Annual Psychological Sciences Poster Night at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Cintron, S.\*, **Boo, C.**, Naigles, L. (October 2022). Child vocalization development coded through the International Phonetic Alphabet: A comparison of children with autism spectrum disorder and typically developing children. Poster presented at the Annual Psychological Sciences Poster Night at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Cintron, S.\*, **Boo, C.**, Naigles, L. (July 2022). Child vocalization development coded through the International Phonetic Alphabet: A comparison of children with autism spectrum disorder and typically developing children. Poster presented at the 10th Annual McNair Scholars Summer Poster Exhibit at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (April 2022). Differentiating among low, medium, and high "um" users with ASD and ADHD. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Carmona, J., **Boo, C.**, & Naigles, L. (April 2022). Internal state language production in storybook versus personal narratives in TD children and children with ASD. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.
- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (November 2021). Difficulties with personal pronouns for school-aged children with ASD and ADHD in a virtual reality task. Poster presented at the Annual Psychological Sciences Poster Night at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT.

- Boo, C.**, McIntyre, N., Mundy, P., & Naigles, L. (May 2021). Discourse marker production by children with ASD, ADHD, and comorbid symptoms of both. Poster presented at the Language Fest at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT (Virtual meeting).
- Boo, C.**, Reichart, C., O'Brien, A., & Gilman, A. (April 2017). Self-reports of "visual" v. "verbal" orientation and EEG results. Poster presented at the Liberal Arts Symposium at Juniata College, Huntingdon, PA.
- He, A., O'Brien, A., **Boo, C.**, Reichart, C., Polisena, D., & Gilman, A. (April 2017). Comparing US and Chinese students' attention to visual backgrounds. Poster presented at the Liberal Arts Symposium at Juniata College, Huntingdon, PA.

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## MENTORING

### *At NYU*

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|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 – present | Nandini Singla, undergraduate honors student in Psychology & Neural Science (Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund recipient and Benjamin P.B. and Fannie L.G. Feldman Research Scholar) |
| 2025 – 2026    | Kyla Peters, undergraduate student in Psychology                                                                                                                                      |
| 2025 – 2026    | Jessie Werthman, undergraduate in Applied Psychology                                                                                                                                  |
| 2025 – 2026    | Maia Arriola, undergraduate student in Applied Psychology & Global Public Health                                                                                                      |
| 2025 – 2026    | Yijun Zhou, undergraduate student in Applied Psychology & Linguistics                                                                                                                 |
| 2024 – present | Meghan Kalvey, doctoral student in Psychology                                                                                                                                         |
| 2024 – 2026    | Grace Boudreau, master's student in Psychology                                                                                                                                        |
| 2024 – 2025    | Yiming Jia, master's student in Data Science                                                                                                                                          |
| 2024 – 2025    | Arya Kotibhaskar, master's student in Data Science                                                                                                                                    |
| 2024 – 2025    | Fantah Camara, undergraduate student in Psychology                                                                                                                                    |

### *At UConn*

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|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 – 2025 | Nolyette Verastegui, undergraduate honors student in Psychology                                 |
| 2023 – 2025 | Izabella Rockhill, undergraduate student in Psychology                                          |
| 2022 – 2024 | Yasmin Andalib, undergraduate honors student in Cognitive Sciences                              |
| 2022 – 2024 | Jaydel Hernandez, undergraduate honors student in Psychology                                    |
| 2022 – 2023 | Sarah Cintron, undergraduate student in Speech, Language, and Hearing Sciences & McNair scholar |
| 2021 – 2023 | Julia Johnson, undergraduate honors student in Cognitive Sciences                               |

### *Other*

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|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 – 2025 | Maya Peralez, undergraduate student in Psychology at University of Texas-Austin & MAGIC mentee |
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## TEACHING

### *University of Connecticut*

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|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fall 2023,<br>Spring 2023 | <b>Teaching Assistant/Guest Lecturer for Language &amp; Racism</b> (COGS/AFRA 2345)<br>Instructors: Drs. Letty Naigles & Bede Agocha<br>Guest lecture topics: Language Inquiry & Word Count (LIWC) software tutorial, linguistics of African American Vernacular English |
| Fall 2022                 | <b>Instructor of Record for General Psychology</b> (PSYC 1100)<br>Lecture topics: developmental psychology, introduction to behavioral neuroscience, perception, memory, moral psychology                                                                                |
| Fall 2021                 | <b>Lab Instructor for Principles of Research in Psychology</b> (PSYC 2100)<br>Instructor: Dr. Steven Mellor<br>Lecture topics: data organization, basic statistics, writing research papers                                                                              |
| Spring 2021,              | <b>Lab Instructor for General Psychology – Honors Section</b> (PSYC 1100)                                                                                                                                                                                                |

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|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fall 2020                                           | Instructors: Drs. Umay Suanda & Till Frank<br>Lecture topics: scientific literacy, basic statistics, data visualization                                                   |
| Spring 2022,<br>Spring 2020                         | <b>Teaching Assistant/Guest Lecturer for Developmental Psychology (PSYC 2400)</b><br>Instructor: Dr. Marie Coppola<br>Guest lecture topics: attachment, moral development |
| Fall 2019                                           | <b>Lab Instructor for General Psychology (PSYC 1100)</b><br>Instructor: Dr. Alex Paxton<br>Lecture topics: scientific literacy, basic statistics, data visualization      |
| <i>Eugene Lang at The New School</i><br>Spring 2019 | <b>Teaching Assistant for Fundamentals of Developmental Psychology (LPSY 2036)</b><br>Instructor: Jessica Engelbrecht, M.S.                                               |

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## SERVICE

### *Academic Service*

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|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 – Present | <b>Mentor</b><br><i>Application Support Group, New York University</i>                                                    |
| 2023 – 2024    | <b>Graduate Student Representative</b><br><i>Cognitive Science Program Steering Committee, University of Connecticut</i>  |
| 2023           | <b>Graduate Student Abstract Reviewer</b><br><i>Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Meeting</i>       |
| 2022 – 2025    | <b>MAGIC Mentor</b><br><i>University of Connecticut</i>                                                                   |
| 2022 – 2023    | <b>Co-Editor of IBACS Brain, Cognition, and Language Digest</b><br><i>University of Connecticut</i>                       |
| 2021 – 2024    | <b>Psychological Sciences Departmental Diversity &amp; Inclusion Taskforce Member</b><br><i>University of Connecticut</i> |
| 2021 – 2023    | <b>Senior Co-Chair of Events Committee</b><br><i>SLAC at the University of Connecticut</i>                                |
| 2021 – 2022    | <b>Diversity, Equity, &amp; Inclusion Committee Member</b><br><i>SLAC at the University of Connecticut</i>                |
| 2020 – 2023    | <b>Language Fest Planning Committee Member</b><br><i>University of Connecticut</i>                                        |
| 2017 – 2019    | <b>Graduate Student Peer Reviewer</b><br><i>The New School Psychology Bulletin</i>                                        |

### *Ad Hoc Journal Reviewer for:*

*Acta Linguistica Academia, Autism Research, Autism & Developmental Language Impairments, Cognition, Journal of Attention Disorders, Journal of Child Language, Speech Communication*

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## OUTREACH

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|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | <b>Psi Chi Induction Ceremony Speaker</b><br><i>University of Connecticut</i>                                                           |
| 2023 | <b>Guest Presenter</b><br><i>Women in STEM Frontiers Research Expo at the University of Connecticut</i>                                 |
| 2022 | <b>Co-Facilitator</b><br><i>Neurodiversity in Education: Building Educator-Researcher Partnerships at the University of Connecticut</i> |
| 2022 | <b>Instructor</b><br><i>Ask a Brain Scientist at the University of Connecticut</i>                                                      |
| 2020 | <b>Guest Panelist</b><br>Applying to Graduate School as a First-Generation Student                                                      |

2020 *Language Creation Lab at the University of Connecticut (Dr. Marie Coppola)*  
**Guest Presenter**  
Applying to Graduate School

2020 *Language Creation Lab at the University of Connecticut (Dr. Marie Coppola)*  
**Guest Presenter**  
Applying to Graduate School as a Cognitive Science Major  
*COGS 3584 at the University of Connecticut (Instructor: Dr. Letty Naigles)*

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## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Psychological Science  
Cognitive Development Society  
Cognitive Science Society  
Eastern Psychological Association  
International Association for the Study of Child Language  
International Pragmatics Association  
International Society for Autism Research  
Society for Research in Child Developmental

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## CERTIFICATIONS

Autism Diagnostic Observation Schedule, 2<sup>nd</sup> Edition (ADOS-2): Clinical Administration, Earned Summer 2022

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